

MITRE ATT&CK: The Shared Language

What ATT&CK is

A curated knowledge base of **adversary tactics and techniques** based on real-world observations. It is not a threat model you choose – it is a common vocabulary used by threat intel, detection engineering, red teams, and vendors alike.

Navigation essentials

attack.mitre.org – the live matrix

Tactics are the columns; **techniques** are the rows (a technique can appear in multiple tactics)

Each technique page contains: **Procedure Examples**, **Mitigations**, **Detection**, **Data Sources**, **Techniques that intersect** (sub-techniques like T1021.001)

The 15 tactics (Enterprise)

Reconnaissance → Resource Development → Initial Access → Execution → Persistence → Privilege Escalation → Defense Evasion → Credential Access → Discovery → Lateral Movement → Collection → Command and Control → Exfiltration → Impact.

Hands-on: reading a technique page

Take **T1219 Remote Access Software** (Command and Control):

Description: legitimate remote access tools (TeamViewer, AnyDesk) used for C2 to blend in

Sub-techniques: apply per tool

Detection: monitor network connections to known remote-access endpoints, application naming anomalies

Mitigation: block employee use of unsanctioned remote tools

Why this matters for every role

Detection engineer: writes Sigma/Splunk detections keyed to technique IDs

SOC analyst: classifies alerts into ATT&CK phases

Red teamer: plans chains as technique sequences

Threat intel: attributes activity groups (e.g., APT groups) by their technique usage

Exercises: pick "T1059.001 Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell" and find one procedure example, one detection, one mitigation. This pattern (technique → detection) is your bread and butter.

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